

The Cloud Shepherd

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



High above the hills lived an old cloud shepherd named Nimbus.

Every morning, he gathered his flock of little clouds.

"Come along, clouds," he called.

"Time to drift."

The little clouds floated after him in a fluffy line.

Nimbus felt proud.

One little cloud, named Puff, was very slow.

She lagged behind the others.

"Hurry, Puff," said Nimbus.

"I'm trying," said Puff.

She felt worried.

She did not want to get lost.

Nimbus had an idea.



He tied an invisible string to Puff.

Not a real string.

A shepherd's string, made of care.

"Now you can drift at your own pace," he said.

"And you will never get lost."

Puff felt relieved.

She drifted slowly behind the flock.

She watched the world below.

She saw green fields.

She saw a winding river.

She saw tiny houses with tiny gardens.

"So pretty, so pretty, so pretty," she whispered.

That was three times she whispered it.



She felt happy.

At noon, the flock stopped over a thirsty farm.

"Rain time," said Nimbus.

The big clouds let their rain fall.

Pitter-patter went the rain on the dry fields.

The farmer waved up at the sky.

"Thank you!" he called.

Puff wanted to help too.

She squeezed out three little drops.

Plip, plip, plip.

"Well done, Puff," said Nimbus.

Puff felt proud.

As evening came, Nimbus led his flock home.

The sun painted them pink and gold.



Puff drifted slowly, as always.

But she was not worried now.

She had her shepherd's string.

She had her place in the flock.

One by one, the clouds settled into the night sky.

Puff found a soft spot near the moon.

She yawned a fluffy yawn.

Sleep now, little cloud.

Dream of drifting slow over quiet fields.

Moral: *Going slowly is fine when someone cares about you.*

The End